Risk assessment: what could go wrong?



Cyber security · Level 4 · Lesson 2

Today we will

- List the school’s information assets.
- Score risks by likelihood and impact on a 3 × 3 grid.
- Choose a control, an owner and a date for the top risks, in a simple register.

Score it, then fix it

- Risk = likelihood × impact (1 to 9)
- Fix the likely and serious first
- Prevent, detect, recover
- Every control has an owner and a date
- Review the register every term

Risk hunt: our top three risks

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the power-cut story and ask what would have saved the exam papers.
2. Assets (7 min): List on the board what the school must protect.
3. Score (13 min): Groups write risks on slips and place them on the 3 × 3 grid.
4. Controls (10 min): For the top three, agree a control, an owner and a date.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Copy the top three into the register and set a review date.

Draw a 3 × 3 grid on the board before the meeting: likelihood from 1 to 3 across, impact from 1 to 3 up, with the corner where 3 meets 3 marked “act now”. Prepare paper slips and tape, and invite the bursar and whoever looks after the computers.

Let’s discuss

1. Which of our risks is likely but dull, and still not fixed?
2. Which control could we put in place this week for free?
3. Who should keep the register, and when do we look at it again?

Exit ticket

- Our highest risk, its score, and one control with an owner.